



MELODEX

User Manual

Everyday listening, sources, Flow, taste memory, playlists and optional AI

Don't shuffle. Flow.

Version 0.2 release candidate



Local-first | Source-neutral | Optional AI

September 2026

Start here

A quick path from first launch to a useful listening session.

FIVE-MINUTE SETUP

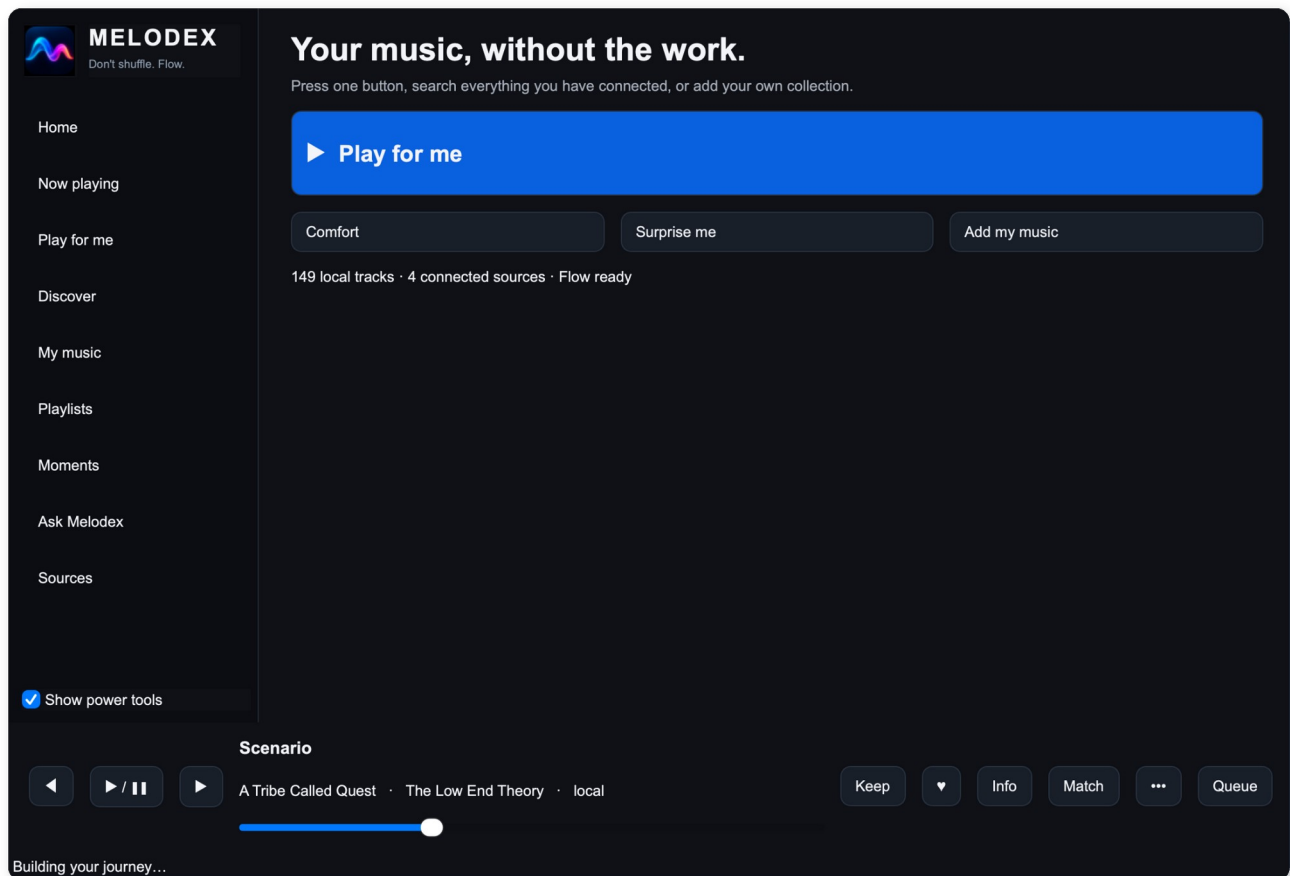
Add a local folder, test one track, open Play for Me, choose a mode and duration, then build a journey. Everything else is optional.

- 1 Open Sources and choose Add local folder.
- 2 Open My music and double-click a track to confirm playback.
- 3 Open Play for Me and choose a mode, duration and Familiar to Surprising level.
- 4 Build the journey and open Queue if you want to inspect what comes next.
- 5 Use Keep and Love as you listen. Melodex stores those taste signals locally.

Melodex 0.2 runs on macOS, Windows and Linux. Android is currently a Provider Bridge client rather than a full standalone desktop-style player.

1. Home: the shortest route to music

The Home screen keeps the first action obvious while leaving deeper tools one click away.

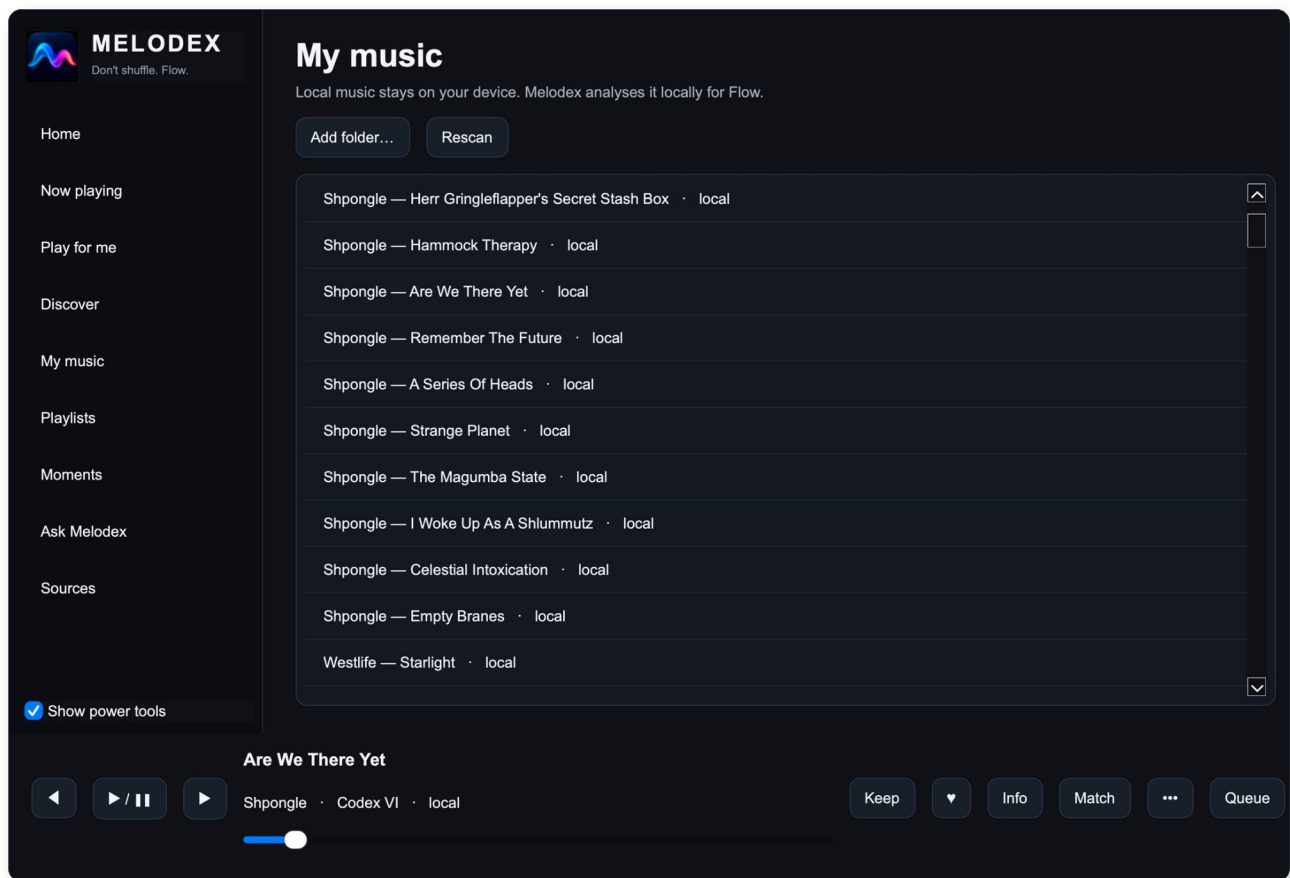


Home - one-click Play for Me, quick comfort/surprise choices, local library count and connected-source status.

Control	What it means
Play for me	Build a listening session from your catalogue, taste history and available analysis.
Comfort	Bias the next session toward known-positive material.
Surprise me	Give Melodex more room to reach beyond your usual choices.
Add my music	Jump directly to adding a local folder.

2. Add your local library

Local music remains on your device. Melodex indexes the folders you choose and reads tags where available.



My music - indexed local files stay in place and can be rescanned at any time.

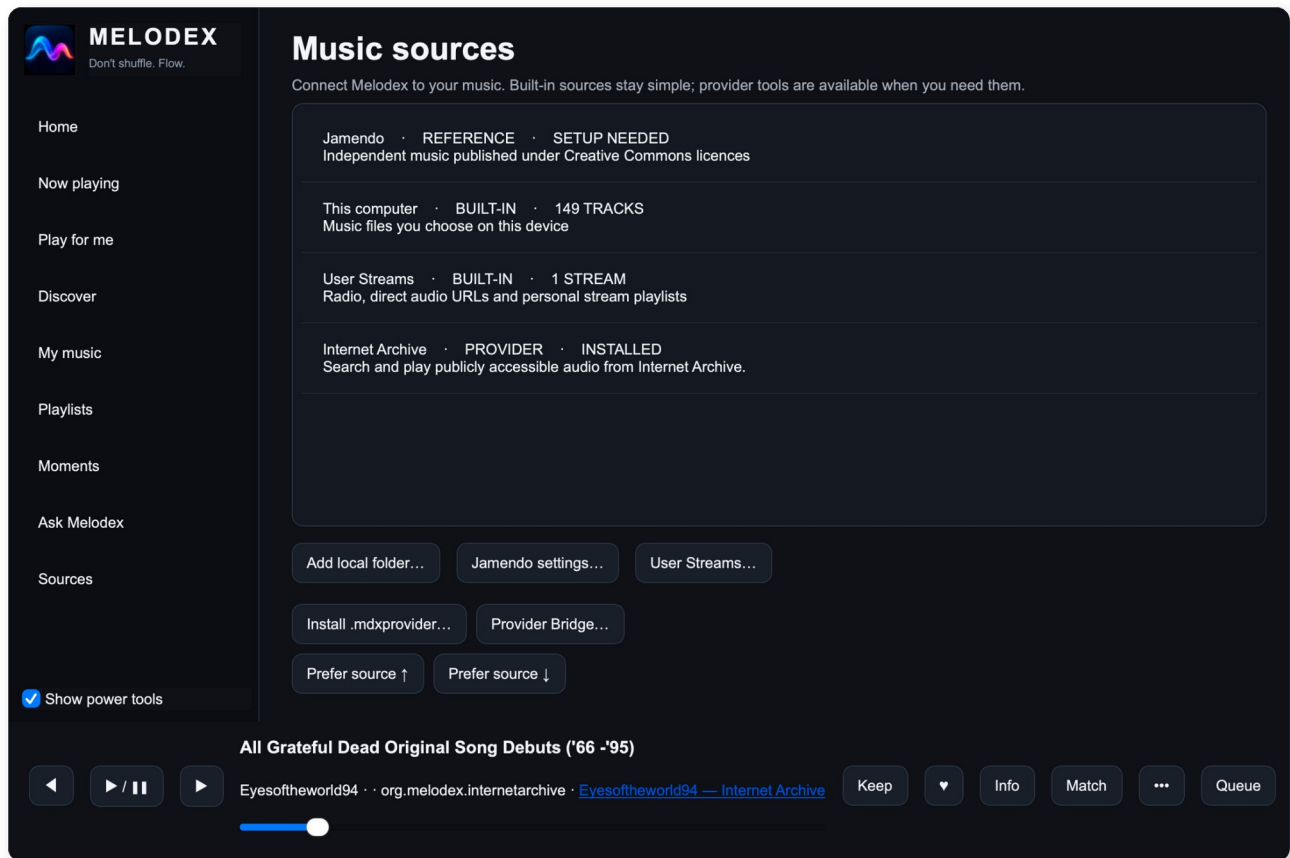
- **Supported formats:** MP3, FLAC, M4A, AAC, OGG, Opus, WAV, AIFF and WMA.
- **Add folder:** choose one or more music folders.
- **Rescan:** refresh the index after adding or changing files.
- **Playback:** double-click a track or add it to the queue.

LOCAL-FIRST

Your music files are not uploaded or moved. Local analysis and taste memory can remain on the same device.

3. Connect music sources

Sources feed one source-neutral player. Built-in options stay simple; provider tools appear only when you need them.

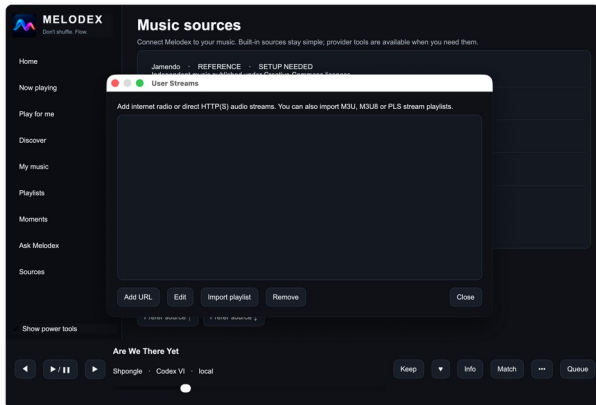


Music sources - This computer, User Streams, Jamendo and the optional Internet Archive provider can coexist.

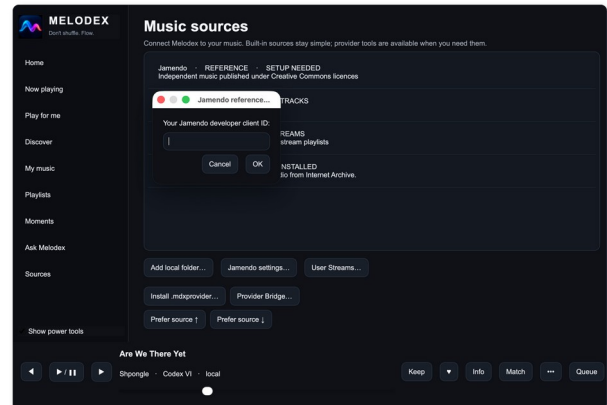
Control	What it means
This computer	Built-in local files.
User Streams	Built-in radio and direct HTTP(S) audio that you explicitly add.
Jamendo	Reference provider using your own developer client ID.
Internet Archive	Official optional provider for publicly accessible Archive audio.
Power tools	Provider installation, bridge controls and source-priority controls.

4. User Streams and Jamendo

Two different ways to add online audio without changing Melodex Core.



User Streams - add direct URLs or import M3U/M3U8/PLS stream playlists.



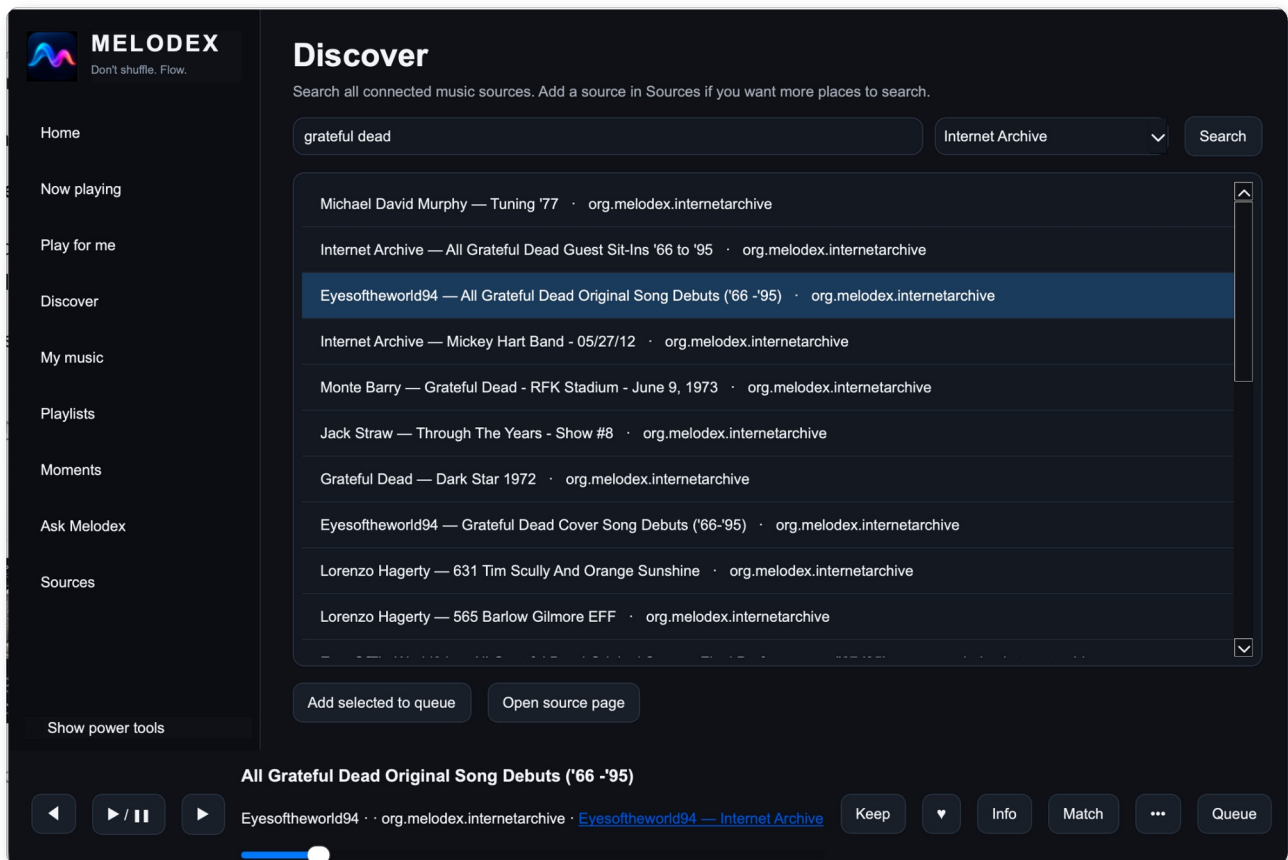
Jamendo - enter your own developer client ID.

User Streams is for endpoints you already know and are authorised to use. It does not discover private URLs or supply credentials.

Jamendo is a reference integration for independent music. Its API, licensing and developer terms remain Jamendo's own.

5. Discover across sources

Search one source or everything you have connected. Results can play immediately or join the current queue.



Discover - Internet Archive results for a Grateful Dead search. The selected result can play or be added to the queue.

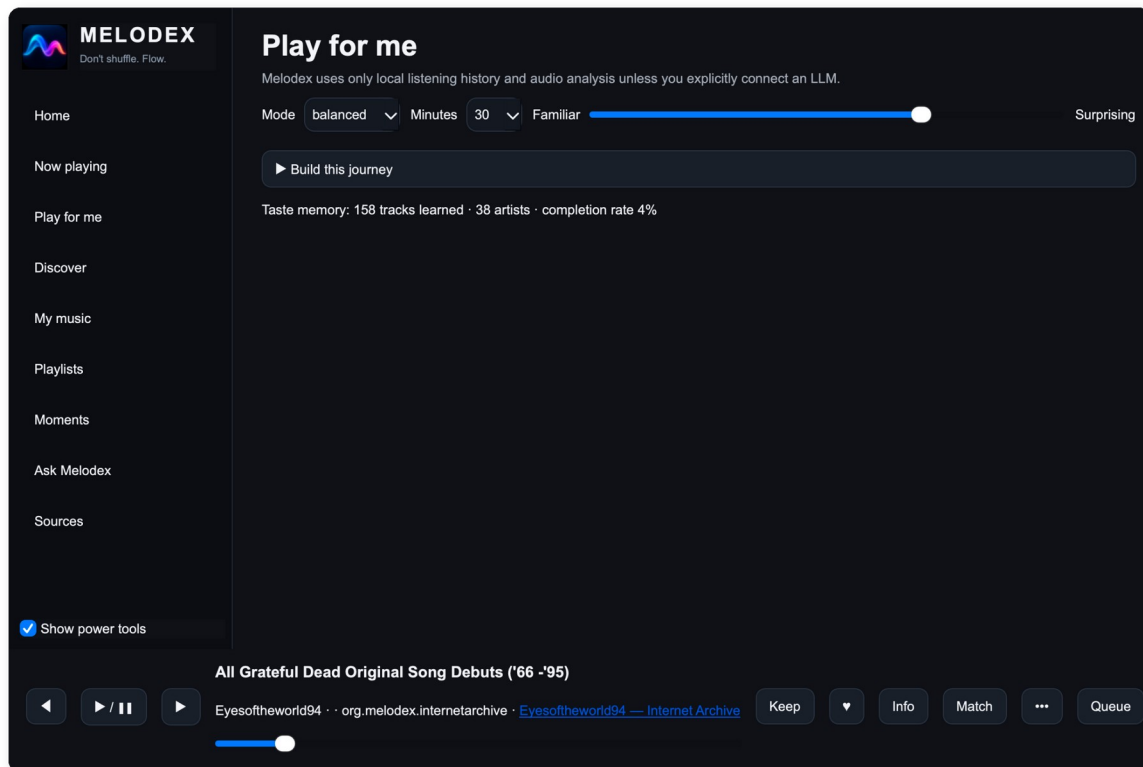
- Choose All sources for a source-neutral search, or select a specific provider.
- Double-click a result to play it.
- Use Add selected to queue when you want the current track to keep playing.
- Use Open source page when a provider exposes a public item page.

EXTERNAL-SOURCE TIMING

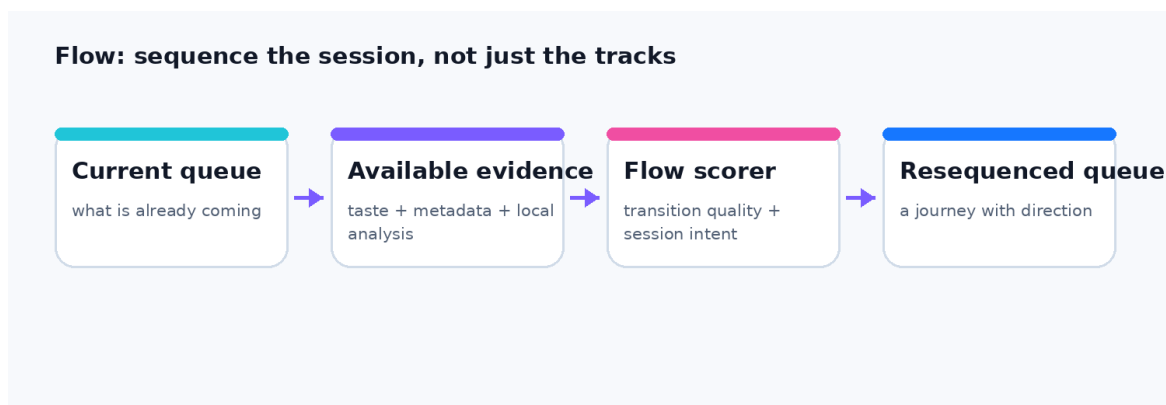
Public archive items may take a few seconds to resolve and buffer. Very large aggregate recordings can take longer than ordinary tracks.

6. Play for Me and Flow

Play for Me describes the session you want. Flow is the sequencing layer that tries to make the queue go somewhere.



Play for Me - choose a mode, duration and Familiar to Surprising level.



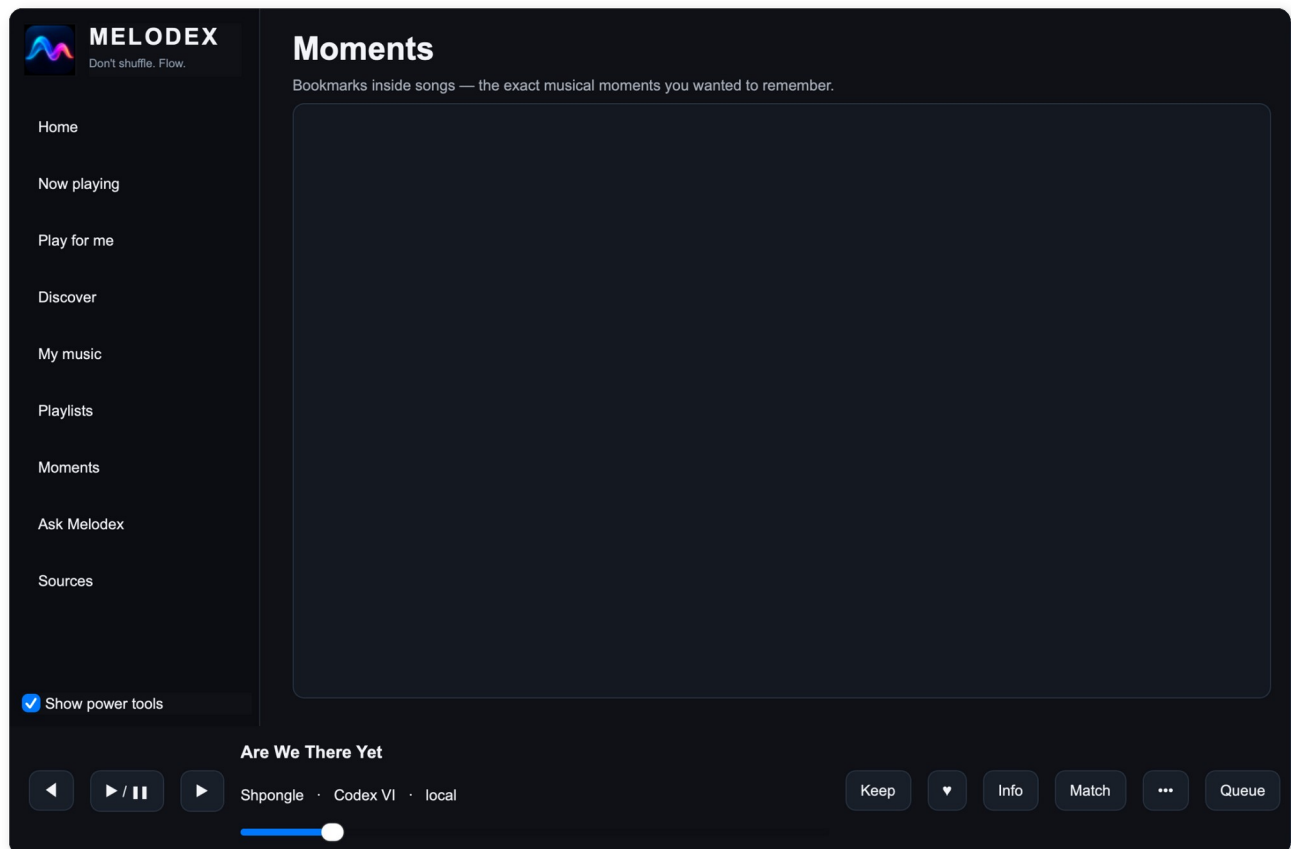
Flow combines session intent with the evidence Melodex actually has, then resequences the queue.

- **Balanced:** familiar with some discovery.
- **Comfort:** stronger preference for known positive signals.
- **Rediscover:** bring back music you liked but have not heard recently.
- **Explore:** increase the novelty budget.
- **Familiar to Surprising:** a per-session control, not a permanent personality setting.

7. Teach Melodex your taste

A few lightweight signals are enough. Melodex does not need a long preference questionnaire.

Control	What it means
Love	Strong positive signal.
Keep	This belongs in my musical world.
Full listen	Useful positive completion evidence.
Early skip	Weak negative evidence, not a permanent verdict.
Moment	Bookmark an exact point inside a track.



Moments - this empty state means no bookmarks have been saved yet. Use the player menu to save an exact playback position.

GOOD SIGNAL, NOT RIGID JUDGEMENT

A single skip can mean many things. Taste memory is designed to accumulate evidence rather than overreact to one action.

8. Rich Now Playing

Playback and music knowledge are deliberately separate. Audio can come from one source while metadata is enriched independently.

MELODEX
Don't shuffle. Flow.

Home
Now playing
Play for me
Discover
My music
Playlists
Moments
Ask Melodex
Sources

Show power tools

Now playing

Artwork, local lyrics, artist relationships and recording credits are enriched independently from the playback source.

goldie lookin chain
KINGS OF CAERLEON

What Would Biggie Do

Goldie Lookin Chain
Kings of Caerleon · 2013

Group | Newport | british · rock and indie · uk · welsh

✓ MusicBrainz match 99% · enrichment complete

[MusicBrainz recording](#) · [artist](#) · [release](#)

Photo: Hamish2k at the English-language Wikipedia · [Commons file](#) · [CC BY-SA 3.0](#)

Artwork: Cover Art Archive

Lyrics **Artist** Releases Credits Info

Goldie Lookin Chain

Welsh comedic rap group

Group · From Newport · Active from 2000

What Would Biggie Do_

Goldie Lookin Chain · Kings of Caerleon · local

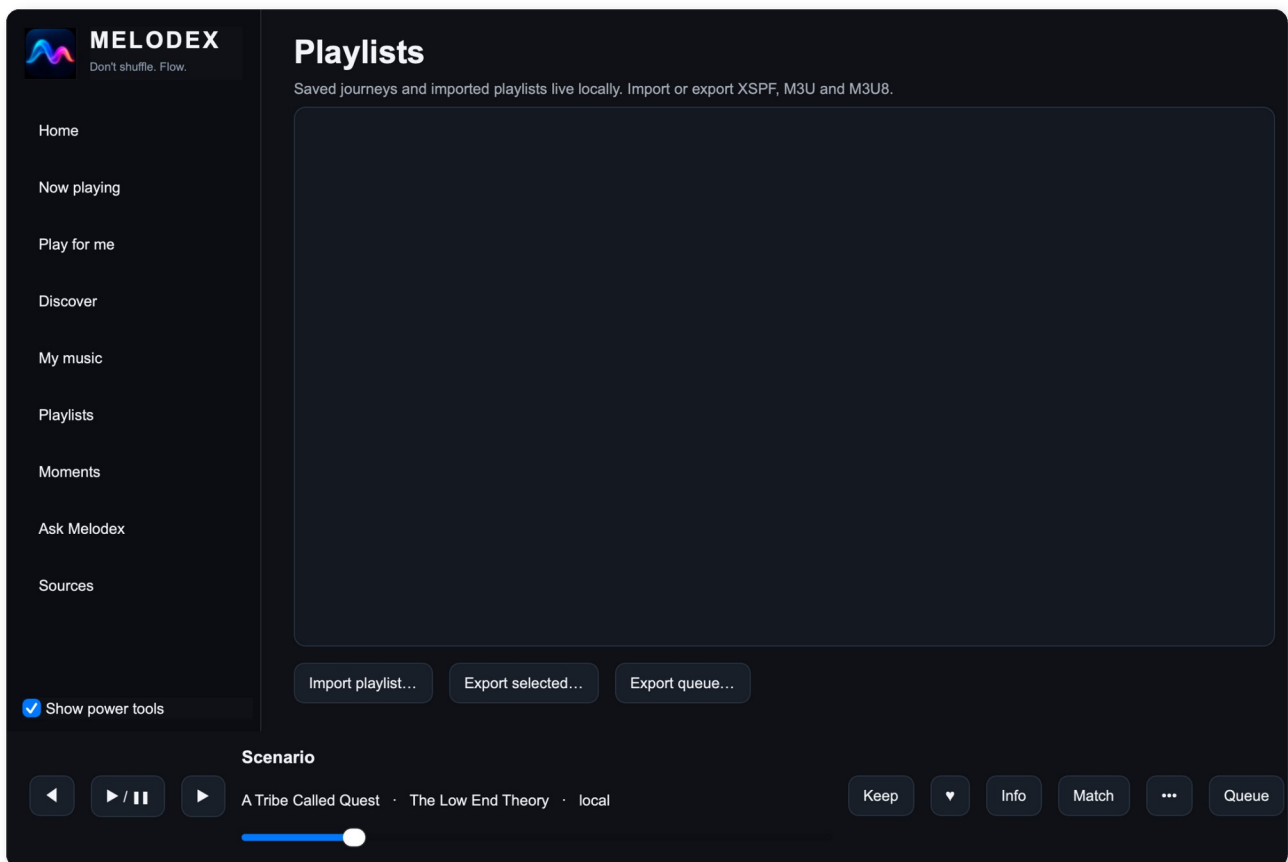
Keep Info Match ... Queue

Now Playing - artwork, MusicBrainz identity, artist context, releases, credits and local lyrics can load progressively.

- MusicBrainz identity, relationships and release data when available.
- Cover Art Archive artwork.
- Wikidata-linked Wikimedia Commons artist images with attribution when available.
- Local embedded lyrics, .lrc synchronized lyrics and .txt sidecars.
- Progressive enrichment so metadata lookups do not need to block playback.

9. Playlists and portable intent

Melodex imports and exports XSPF, M3U and M3U8. A playlist can describe what should play without forcing every listener to use the same source.



Playlists - import, export a saved playlist, or export the current queue.

- Local paths remain direct local entries.
- HTTP(S) media URLs can remain direct stream entries.
- Metadata-only entries can be resolved against the listener's own connected sources.
- Melodex preserves richer provider identity where the playlist format allows it.

10. When the match is wrong

The Universal Resolver searches connected sources and scores candidate matches. Resolver memory is per requested song, not a blanket provider preference.

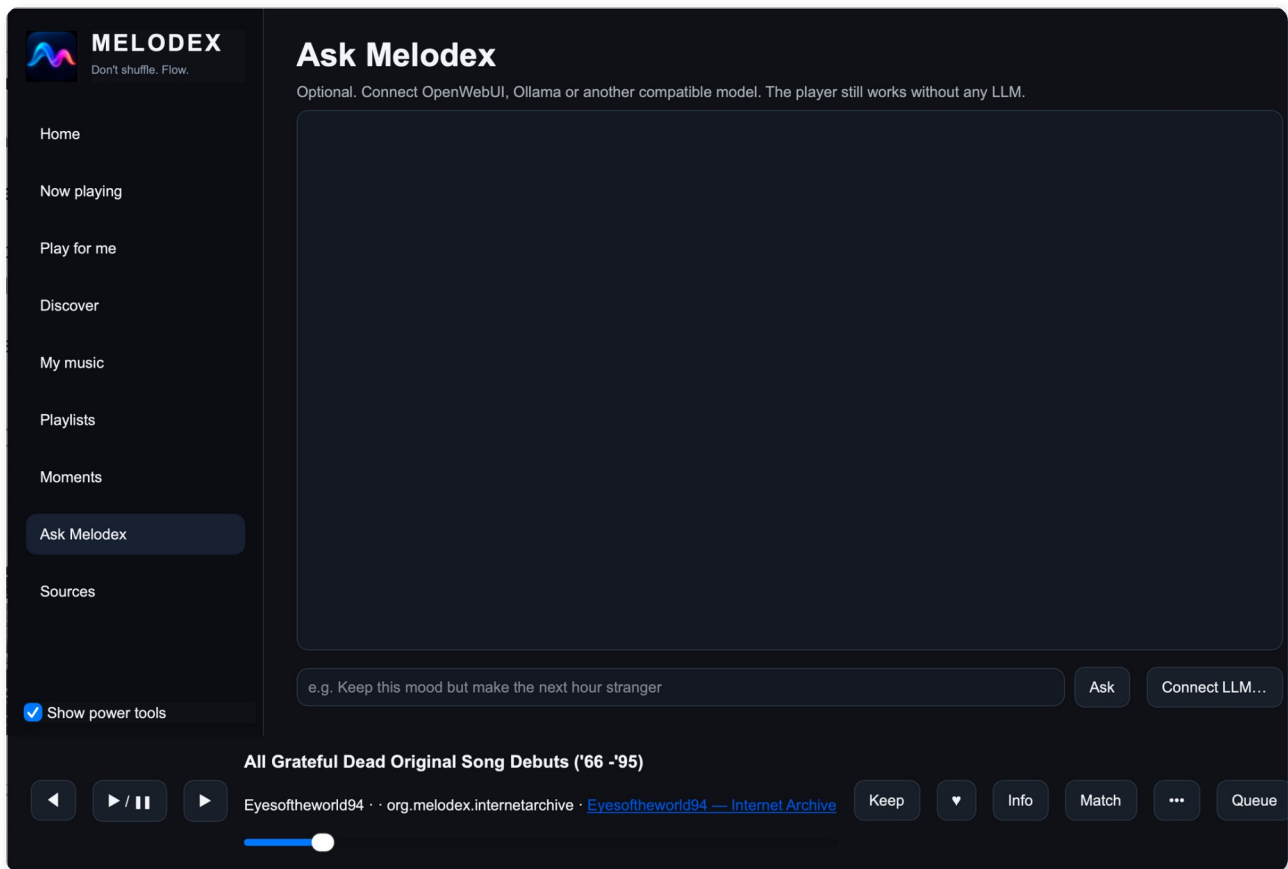
Control	What it means
Play this match	Use the selected candidate once.
Prefer	Remember this candidate for this requested song.
Wrong match	Block this exact result for this requested song only.
Reset memory	Clear the preference and wrong-match blocks for the song.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Live, remastered, acoustic and similarly named versions can coexist across several sources. Match memory lets you correct one song without disabling an entire provider.

11. Ask Melodex: optional AI control

The player still works without an LLM. If you connect one, natural language becomes another control surface.



Ask Melodex - connect OpenWebUI, Ollama or another compatible model only if you want natural-language control.

Useful prompts:

- Keep this mood, but make the next hour stranger.
- Give me a 45-minute session that starts familiar and gets more energetic.
- Rediscover something I used to like.
- Flow this queue.
- Save this moment as great bass entrance.

PRIVACY BOUNDARY

Provider headers, cookies, refresh tokens, signed playback URLs and local paths are removed from LLM/control status responses.

12. Android, privacy and updates

Android currently uses the authenticated Provider Bridge. Application files and user data are stored separately.

```
music/provider -> Melodex desktop -> Provider Bridge -> Android
```

- **Bridge:** use it on a trusted LAN and treat the bearer token like a password.
- **macOS data:** ~/Library/Application Support/Melodex/
- **Windows data:** %APPDATA%\Melodex\
- **Linux data:** ~/.local/share/melodex/ unless XDG_DATA_HOME is set.
- **Updates:** replacing the application should not normally remove local taste/settings data.

DO NOT EXPOSE THE RAW BRIDGE PORT

For remote access, use a trusted VPN or an HTTPS reverse proxy rather than simple public port forwarding.

13. Troubleshooting and quick reference

Start with a known-good local file. If local playback works, a problem is more likely to be source-specific.

Control	What it means
No local tracks	Confirm the folder contains supported audio and rescan it.
Archive is slow	A few seconds can be normal; very large files may take longer.
Deeper Flow unavailable	Install FFmpeg and restart Melodex. Reduced-mode Flow still works.
Provider will not install	Developers can run melodex-provider validate and doctor.
Android cannot connect	Check LAN IP, firewall, bearer token and same-network access.
LLM connection fails	Check endpoint, model name, API key if required and network reachability.

Melodex is source-neutral, local-first and usable without AI. The simplest successful setup is still: local folder -> play a track -> Play for Me -> listen.

Don't shuffle. Flow.